

PSME Macroeconomics

Break homework assignment (30%) - Commentary on a news article

Deadline: 5.11.2026, 23:59, send by email to Liza: elizaveta.burina@univ-paris1.fr

Rationale

This assignment enables you to demonstrate the application of your knowledge and understanding of macroeconomic theory in relation to real-world situations.

Articles

The article may be from a newspaper, a journal or the internet, but must not be from television or radio broadcasts. It should not be a lengthy one, 1-1,5 pages after you copy it in a Word document. Article must have been published no earlier than one year before the deadline (the earliest publication date allowed: 5.11.2025).

The article on which the commentary is based should, where possible, be in English. If an extract in another language is used, you must provide an accurate translation of the whole article.

Focus

The commentary must:

- explain the links between the article and economic theory seen in class
- demonstrate economic insights into the implications of the article (that is, it should provide evidence of the your ability to discuss current events from the point of view of an economist).

Title page must contain:

- the title of the article
- the source of the article (including date of access to the site if from the internet)
- the date the article was published
- the word count of the commentary (the limit is 800 words)

Include the text of the article in the commentary document.

The four criteria: total marks = 11

Criterion A: Diagrams

This criterion assesses the extent to which you are able to construct and explain diagrams.

Marks	Descriptor
0	The work does not reach a standard described by the descriptors below.
1	Relevant diagram(s) are included but not explained, or the explanations are incorrect.
2	Relevant, accurate and correctly labelled diagram(s) are included, with a limited explanation.
3	Relevant, accurate and correctly labelled diagram(s) are included, with a full explanation.

Criterion B: Terminology

This criterion assesses the extent to which you use appropriate economic terminology

Marks	Descriptor
0	The work does not reach a standard described by the descriptors below.
1	Economic terminology relevant to the article is included in the commentary.
2	Economic terminology relevant to the article is used appropriately throughout the commentary.

Criterion C: Application and analysis

This criterion assesses the extent to which you recognize, understand, apply and analyse economic theory in the context of the article.

Marks	Descriptor
0	The work does not reach a standard described by the descriptors below.
1	Relevant economic theory is applied to the article with limited analysis.
2	Relevant economic theory is applied to the article throughout the commentary with appropriate economic analysis.
3	Relevant economic theory is applied to the article throughout the commentary with effective economic analysis.

Criterion D: Evaluation

This criterion assesses the extent to which your own judgments are supported by reasoned argument.

Marks	Descriptor
0	The work does not reach a standard described by the descriptors below.
1	Judgments are made that are supported by limited reasoning.
2	Judgments are made that are supported by appropriate reasoning.
3	Judgments are made that are supported by effective and balanced reasoning.

Thus, you should choose a purely factual news article allowing you to conduct your own evaluation. That is why the articles from «The Economist» might not be the best.

Generally suitable sources: CNN, Reuters, Bloomberg, BBC, CNBC